Information Asset Register: approach and key findings

Briefing for the Information Security Steering Committee

October 2026 | Augustine Ozor, GRC Analyst

15

assets before



45

assets in the register today

Why a register, and why now



Audit observation

We are ISO 27001 certified, yet the previous auditor noted we have never kept a formal asset register.



PayStream assets

The 2025 acquisition brings 40+ new assets that need owners, classification and risk ratings.



HIPAA and PCI DSS

Both require precise inventories of systems and the regulated data they hold.

How we built the register



Collect

CTO spreadsheets and system documentation, reviewed against the 15 template assets

Classify

Four-level data classification and four-level business criticality from the Classification Guide

Assign

Named owner, custodian and business unit for every asset

Assess and review

Risk level, regulatory relevance, dependencies and a review date

14 required fields per asset: ID, name, description, category, owner, custodian, business unit, classification, criticality, location, regulatory relevance, dependencies, risk level, review date

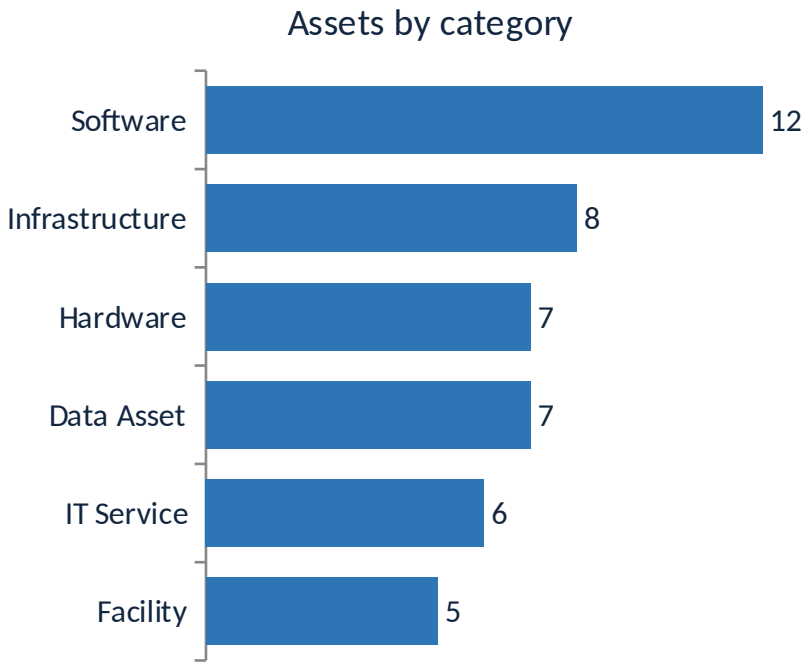
The register at a glance

45
assets registered

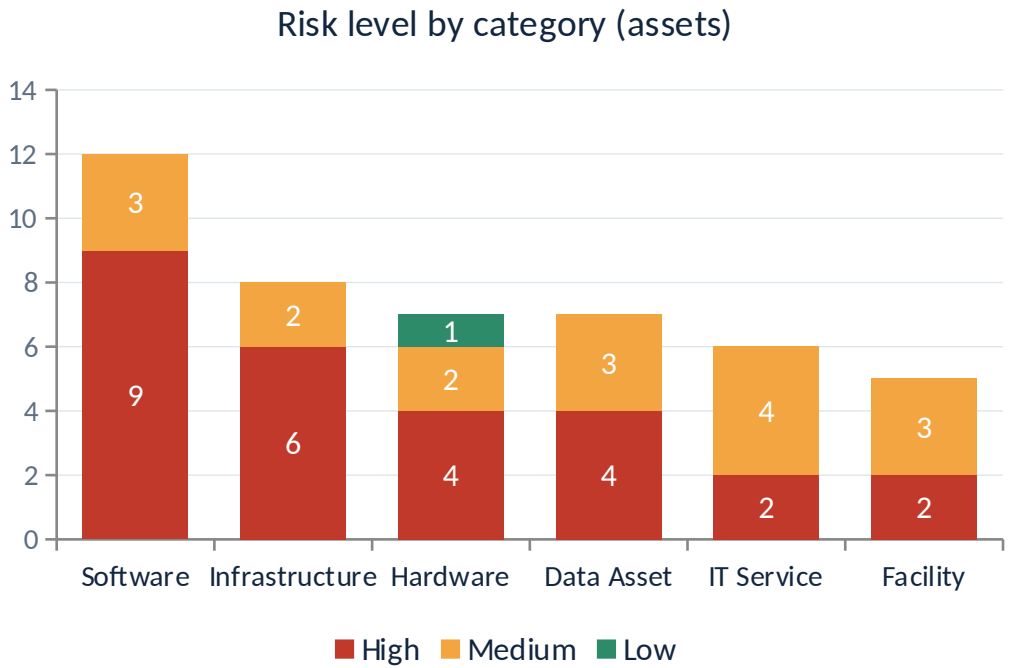
8
from PayStream Analytics

13
Restricted data assets

28
rated Critical



Most critical assets carry high risk



27 of 45

assets (60%) are rated High risk and need formal treatment

23 of 28

Critical assets are also rated High risk

Risk levels are initial judgments pending formal risk assessment.

Four findings for the ISSC

9 and 9

AWS Production Account and Microsoft Entra ID each support nine other assets, so they are single points of concentration.

14 of 45

assets (31%) sit in the HQ data center or server room, with one recorded DR site as the fallback.

23 critical

assets are rated High risk, which calls for formal risk treatment under the guide.

5 owners

hold 26 of 45 assets (58%), so accountability rests with a few managers.

PayStream: first tranche recorded

8 of 40+

assets recorded; 32 or more still to discover

- 7 of 8 rated High risk; 5 hold Restricted data
- Legacy Active Directory and AWS account are not yet aligned to NexusGuard baselines
- Entries are provisional; review date set to 15 Dec 2026

ID	Asset	Classification	Risk
AST-038	Payment Analytics Platform	Restricted	High
AST-039	Cardholder Data Environment	Restricted	High
AST-040	Transaction Data Warehouse	Restricted	High
AST-041	Payment HSM	Restricted	High
AST-042	Customer API Gateway	Confidential	High
AST-043	AWS Account	Restricted	High
AST-044	Legacy Active Directory	Confidential	High
AST-045	Corporate Email Tenant	Confidential	Medium

Decisions requested from the ISSC

1. **Approve the register** as the authoritative asset inventory, owned by the CISO and reviewed at least quarterly.
2. **Require owner attestation** from every asset owner to confirm entries within 30 days.
3. **Fund PayStream discovery** to find the remaining 32+ assets within 90 days.
4. **Start risk treatment** for the 23 Critical, High-risk assets, beginning with AWS, Entra ID and the cardholder environment.
5. **Embed the register** in procurement and change management so new assets are recorded at onboarding.